

Processor

The PlayBook uses a 1 GHz Cortex-A9 dual-core processor, which results in a very slick, lag-free user experience.

Operating System

RIM chose to adopt the relatively-niche QNX operating system for the BlackBerry PlayBook. Much

like using a BlackBerry phone, QNX focuses on multi-tasking and gesture-based controls for quick navigation. It's a clean and simple interface with lots of room for customisation as well as a smart notifications bar.



BlackBerry PlayBook

Apps

BlackBerry users have never had much joy when it comes to the paltry offerings the App World store sells, but the news that the PlayBook wouldn't even support the existing mobile applications currently on offer came as a true shock. As a result, only a minuscule amount of apps are available to PlayBook owners in comparison to iPad users. Eventual Android app support will address this somewhat, but the few native BlackBerry apps are a disappointment.

Video

It's easier to get your own video files on the PlayBook, and it seems happier to play back a greater variety of file types without conversion, it lacks a dedicated video store.

Web Browsing

The PlayBook's browser is every bit a match for the iPad 2 in terms of web surfing ease, with equally intuitive gesture controls and accurate page rendering. It pips the iPad 2 to the post thanks to its excellent Flash rendering however, making the whole web truly available on the go.

Email

A strange point to highlight you may think, but email support may be the real deciding factor for BlackBerry-owning, tablet fence sitters. While online webmail services are accessible to both the iPad 2 and PlayBook, only the